

marketable skills, so she took up sewing at home. Her daughter, a high-school junior, got a job in the school office during weekdays and a job baby-sitting on weekends.

By her senior year, she had moved from the school office to a local attorney's office as a part of a school-work program. He was so impressed by her maturity and work ethic that he sponsored her to go to a court stenographer's school when she graduated from high school.

She later did all of his personal courtroom reporting and was earning a salary in excess of \$20,000 a year. Within three years, he had helped her to start her own transcription business, and at 24 she was managing an office with four transcription secretaries. She matured through her problems. Unfortunately, not all teenagers do.

Even with children who are out of school and working while living at home, the decision about charging them room and board is not simple. In great part, it will depend on the needs and attitude of the child. Even if the parents don't need the money, I believe it's a good practice to charge working children. They need the accountability that paying their own expenses can provide. You can always put the money in a savings account and give it back to them later when they move out on their own.

(6) *Adult decisions.* Ideally what we would like to achieve with our children is to totally prepare them to make the financial decisions they will be facing as adults. But most of them won't be trained to make decisions such as which house to buy, what type of life insurance to purchase and how much, et cetera.

The best way to prepare them, outside of actually buying those items, is to simulate the needs. In other words, do role-playing in which they make decisions similar to those they will make on their own. I have done this many times with high school classes where I would pair kids into teams to learn basic financial planning. I assign each team (usually a boy and girl) a job and related salary. For instance, one team is a schoolteacher making \$15,000 annually; another is a dentist